RedCup — Final Model

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RedCup in one line

RedCup is India's pay-for-results creator marketing platform: brands post campaigns, eligible creators apply, RedCup shortlists the best fit, the brand picks who to award, and creators earn a guaranteed base per approved reel plus pay for every verified view.

Pitch: Meta Ads, but with real creators — brands pay a small base, then only for verified views.

For	What they get
Brands (D2C and small businesses, pan-India)	A shortlist of the best-fit creators for their niche, the final say on who's selected, approval of every draft, verified results, budgets from ₹5,000
Creators (any follower count)	Guaranteed base per approved reel, more for every verified view, UPI payout in about a week, a public record of results
Agencies and partners	Run client campaigns on RedCup or earn referral fees

What makes it different: results over followers, numbers from Instagram's own data, money held upfront, public results boards, and rankings that can't be bought.

The model

Every campaign is a bounty: a reel brief the brand funds upfront. Eligible creators apply, RedCup shortlists the best fit, and the brand awards it. Creators are paid a base for approved, live work and a performance amount for verified views.

How a campaign runs (about 2–3 weeks)

1. **Brand posts the campaign:** brief, eligibility criteria (followers, niche, city, language), base per creator tier, rate per 1,000 views, budget and number of creators — and funds it through the payment partner.
2. **Eligible creators apply:** creators who meet the criteria get a WhatsApp alert and apply.

3. **RedCup shortlists:** we filter applicants by niche, past results and fit for the campaign, and send the brand a shortlist.
4. **Brand selects and awards:** the brand picks its creators; each awarded creator's maximum earning is reserved from the budget.
5. **Creative direction and draft:** awarded creators get the brand's direction, make the reel and send a draft; the brand approves it or asks for one change.
6. **Creator posts** the approved reel with the Paid Partnership label.
7. **Tracking and payout:** RedCup tracks verified views for 7 days, checks for fraud, and pays by UPI.
8. **Results:** a public results board ranks every awarded creator; unused budget goes back to the brand.

How creators are paid

- **Base:** paid once the approved reel has been live 7 days. It starts from the creator's follower tier and, after 3 bounties, is set by their own results.
- **Performance:** a rate per 1,000 verified views, set by the brand.
- **Cap:** base + performance can't exceed the per-creator maximum. Fake views cancel both.

Creator tier	Base per approved reel (to confirm with the creator survey)
Nano (1K–10K)	₹500–1,500
Micro (10K–50K)	₹1,500–5,000
Mid (50K–2 lakh)	₹5,000–15,000
Proven (3+ bounties)	About 30% of their typical verified views × rate

Business model

RedCup earns on both sides of every bounty — about 22% of the money that flows through it — and adds service fees on top. It stays a platform: services must never become most of the revenue.

Revenue stream	Who pays	Price	From
Platform fee	Brand	15% on top of the bounty budget (+18% GST on the fee)	Launch

Revenue stream	Who pays	Price	From
Creator commission	Creator	10% of each payout	Launch
Managed campaigns	Brand	₹5,000–15,000 per campaign	Launch
Growth package	Brand	₹25,000–40,000 a month + bounty budgets	Month 2
Agency partners	Agency	Reduced 12% platform fee on client bounties	Month 3
Partner referrals	Service partner	Agreed share of work RedCup refers	Launch
Content rights, Creator Pro, featured bounties	Brands, creators	Licence fees, subscriptions, labelled placements	2027
RedCup Score data	Brands, agencies	Data and reports	2028

Unit economics of one bounty

	Amount
Bounty budget	₹50,000
Brand pays (budget + 15% fee + GST on fee)	₹58,850
RedCup platform fee	₹7,500
RedCup creator commission (10% of ₹50,000 if fully used)	₹5,000
Payment gateway costs (~2%)	~₹1,200
RedCup net per fully used bounty	**~₹11,300**

What drives it: repeat brands (target 40%+ funding a second bounty within 60 days), budget fill rate (80%+ of each budget earned by creators), and average bounty size.

What we launch with

We launch pan-India in late October 2026 with the smallest product that runs a real paid bounty end to end; everything else is done by hand until it's proven.

In at launch	Out at launch (done by hand or later)
Brand sign-up, verification, bounty builder with base tiers, checkout	Live brand dashboard — weekly WhatsApp report instead
Creator sign-up with WhatsApp number, Instagram connect, PAN and UPI	Automatic WhatsApp alerts — sent by hand at first
Campaign feed and applications, RedCup shortlist, brand selection, draft upload and approval	Results boards — posted by hand as images at first
View tracking (Instagram API, or screen-recorded insights checked by us until Meta approves)	RedCup Score, leaderboards, brand badges
UPI payouts through the payment partner, admin review queue	Automatic fraud scoring — reviewed by hand
Self-serve and Managed packages	Growth package, agency accounts, content rights
Instagram Reels	YouTube Shorts

Launch offer (proposed): first 20 Founding Brands pay no platform fee on their first bounty (up to ₹25,000), and RedCup writes the brief and picks creators for them.

Launch targets

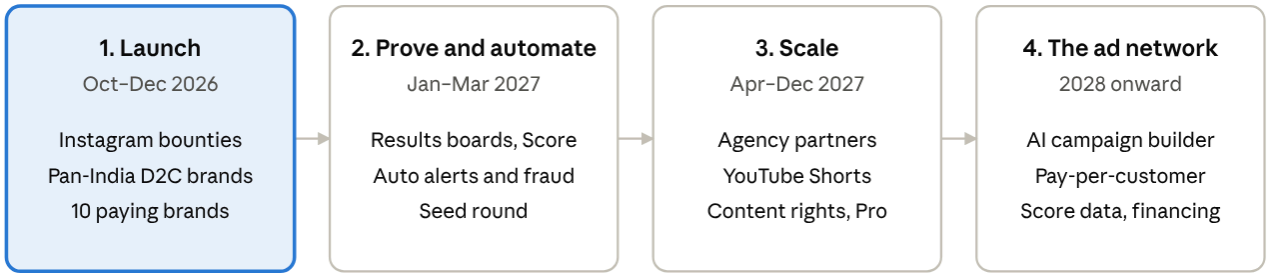
By	Target
Launch day	100+ creator survey responses; 200 creators signed up; 3–5 funded bounties live
End of November	10 paying brands; first results boards published
Mid-January 2027	40%+ of brands fund a second bounty — the go/no-go check

Before taking any money: payment partner account approved, terms of service and privacy policy live, GST invoicing ready, and Meta app review applied for.

Expansion plan

RedCup grows in four phases, and each one starts only when the last one proves itself — the first gate is 40% of brands coming back by mid-January 2027.

Four phases from first bounty to creator ad network



expansion roadmap · 2026 to 2028

How each phase expands

- **Launch:** win D2C brands across India, starting with categories where reels sell (beauty, food and beverage, fashion); prove creators deliver and brands return.
- **Prove and automate:** turn everything done by hand into software — alerts, results boards, the RedCup Score, fraud checks — then raise a seed round on real repeat-brand numbers.
- **Scale:** bring in agencies as a sales channel, add YouTube Shorts, and sell content rights so the best reels become paid ads.
- **The ad network:** brands set a goal and budget and RedCup's AI runs the campaign; pay-per-customer for local businesses through creator QR codes and coupons; the RedCup Score becomes a data product and the base for creator financing.

Path to a ₹100 crore valuation (assumptions)

Year	Campaign spend through RedCup	RedCup revenue
Year 1	~₹1 crore	~₹20 lakh
Year 2	₹15–20 crore	₹3–4 crore
Year 3	₹50–70 crore	₹10–15 crore

The bigger prize is ad budgets, not influencer budgets: small businesses already spend on boosting posts, and RedCup offers them real creators with verified results instead.